

Marks & Sketching



Class 6 · Wednesday, September 16, 2026

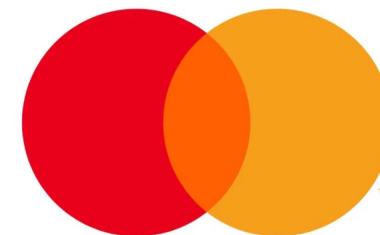
Mark Types

Pictogram / Icon



Apple, Target, Shell

Abstract Symbol



Nike, Mitsubishi, Mastercard

Monogram



IBM, GE, HP

Logotype / Wordmark

The Google logo is a wordmark consisting of the word "Google" in a sans-serif typeface. Each letter is a different color: 'G' is blue, 'o' is red, 'o' is yellow, 'g' is blue, 'l' is green, and 'e' is red.The Coca-Cola logo is a wordmark featuring the brand name in a red, cursive script typeface.The FedEx logo is a wordmark where "Fed" is in purple and "Ex" is in orange, both in a bold sans-serif font. A registered trademark symbol (®) is located to the right of the word.

Google, Coca-Cola, FedEx

Combination Mark



Burger King, Adidas, Starbucks

The Five Mark Types

- Pictogram / Icon
- Abstract Symbol
- Monogram
- Logotype / Wordmark
- Combination Mark

Idea Generation

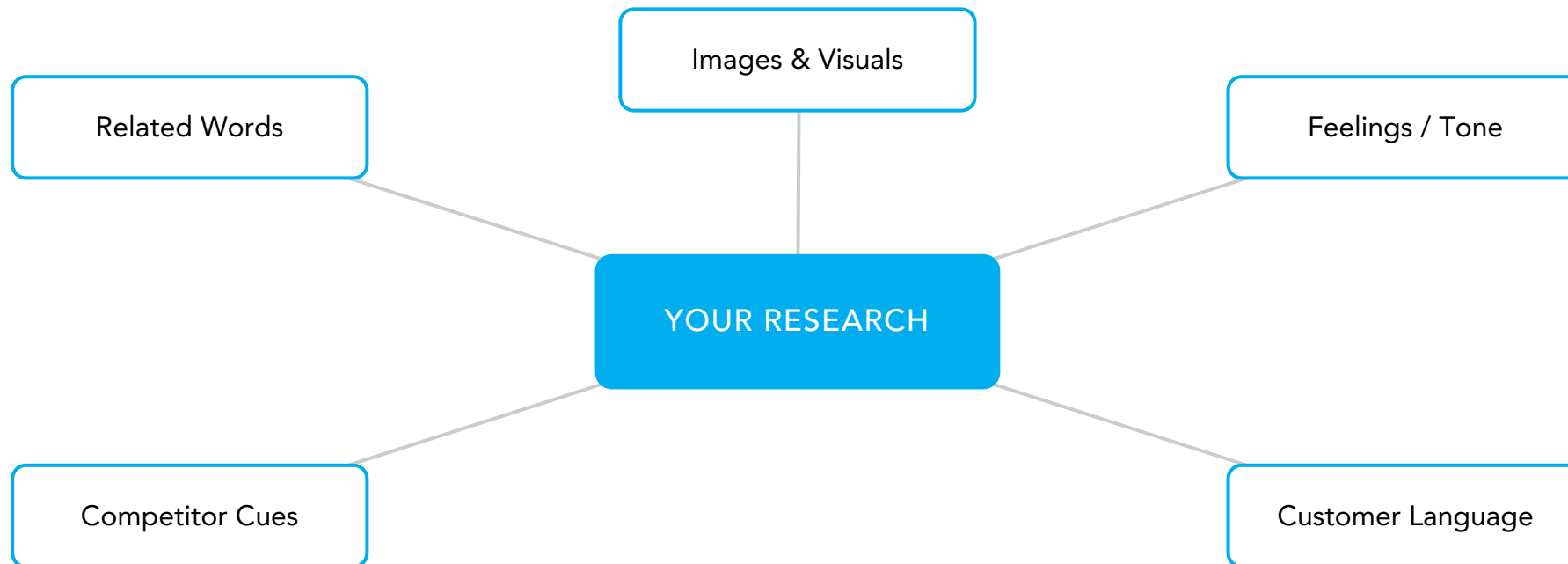
Visual Vocabulary

You already have the research. Look for patterns and inspiration within and across your boards.

- Analyze the images, colors, type, patterns, textures, motifs, and shapes
- What patterns do you notice?
- What feeling ties the boards together?
- Sketch ideas based on these findings

Mind-Mapping

Dig into the research you've already built, don't generate it fresh.



Forced Connections

Pair your business with something unrelated. The friction sparks ideas you wouldn't reach directly.

- Pick a random object, word, or image
- Force a connection: what do they have in common?
- Sketch what that connection looks like as a mark
- The weirder the pairing, the better the surprise

Metaphor & Visual Pun

Find a symbol that means two things at once: literal, and something clever underneath.

FEDEX



An arrow hidden in the negative space between E and x

MR. CHICKEN



A chicken head revealed by the r and period

SCAMPER

Take an existing sketch and run it through each prompt to generate variations.

- Substitute: swap one element for another
- Combine: merge it with a different idea
- Adapt: borrow a solution from somewhere else
- Modify: change scale, proportion, or weight
- Put to another use: see it in a different context
- Eliminate: remove an element and see what's left
- Reverse: flip an assumption (invert figure/ground, flip direction)

Rapid-Fire Timer

Beat perfectionism: set a timer, sketch fast, don't edit as you go.

- Set a timer: 2 minutes, no more
- Draw as many marks as you can in that window
- No erasing, no second-guessing, no perfect lines
- Volume first, judgment later

Concept Sketching

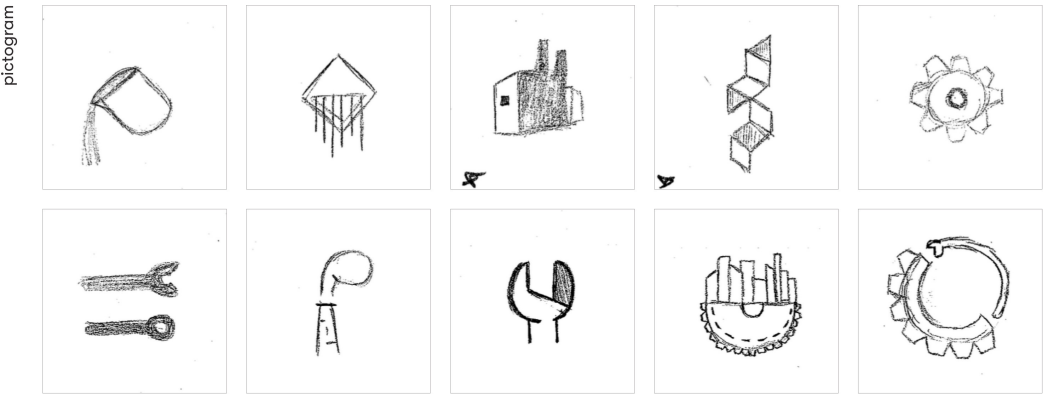
The Objective

Starts tonight, continues outside class. For BOTH of your finalist businesses, not narrowed yet.

- 25 sketches for each of the 5 mark types, per business
- That's 125 sketches per business, 250 total
- Quantity over polish: fast, loose, exploratory
- All sketches, even the bad ones, go in your process book

Roughs vs. High-Contrast

ROUGHS



Fast, messy, quantity -- divergent thinking, every idea out

HIGH-CONTRAST



Clean, bold, black and white -- convergent thinking, refinement

The Sketching Process

I'll check in randomly. Wave me over anytime you want eyes on something.

- 1. Sketch fast
 - Generate as many ideas as you can, no filtering (tonight)
- 2. Step away
 - Let it sit before you judge it
- 3. Come back and pick your best ideas
- 4. Redraw your picks at higher fidelity
 - This becomes your High-Contrast Drawings

High Contrast Drawings



Your picks, redrawn clean. This is what gets critiqued Monday.

High Contrast Drawings

Ready to turn in:

- One 11x17 sheet per business, two sheets total
- All 5 mark types on each sheet, about 3x3 inches each
- Clean, bold, black and white only, no gray
- Labeled by mark type
- Due Wed Sep 23

Monday: Critique Day

We'll critique your drawings as a class.

- Pin your sketches to the board
- Everyone gathers around, shares, and discusses
- Structured feedback: what's working, what to refine
- Leave with new ideas and clarity on what to move forward vs. what to drop

Coming Up

- Mon Sep 21: Critique day
- Wed Sep 23: High-Contrast Drawings due

Questions?

Let's get sketching.